# Problem solving and decision making questions

Here are a few behavioral questions related to problem solving and decision making:

## Question 1: How do you approach problem-solving and debugging when faced with a complex issue in your code?

**Intention of the question**: The interviewer wants to understand your problem-solving skills, debugging techniques, and your ability to analyze and resolve complex technical issues.

**Pitfalls to avoid**: Avoid suggesting that you never face complex issues in your code or that you rely solely on others to resolve them. Don't give an example where you failed to solve the problem or did not learn from the experience.

**Sample Answer 1**: When faced with a complex issue in my code, I first try to understand the problem by reproducing it and gathering as much information as possible. I then break the problem down into smaller, manageable parts and tackle each part systematically. For example, when I encountered a performance issue in an application, I used profiling tools to identify the bottleneck and then applied optimization techniques to improve the performance. By addressing the issue step by step, I was able to resolve it efficiently and effectively.

**Sample Answer 2**: When dealing with a complex coding issue, I follow a systematic approach to problem-solving. I start by reviewing the code and attempting to reproduce the issue. I then use debugging tools and log analysis to gather more information about the problem. Once I have a clear understanding of the issue, I brainstorm potential solutions and evaluate their feasibility. Finally, I implement the chosen solution and test it thoroughly to ensure the issue is resolved. This methodical approach has helped me tackle numerous complex problems in my career.

## Question 2: How do you handle situations where you are unsure of how to proceed or solve a problem? Can you provide an example?

**Intention of the question**: The interviewer wants to assess your ability to deal with uncertainty, seek help when needed, and your willingness to learn and adapt in challenging situations.

**Pitfalls to avoid**: Avoid suggesting that you never face situations where you are unsure of how to proceed or that you are unwilling to seek help when needed. Don't give an example where you failed to find a solution or did not learn from the experience.

**Sample Answer 1**: When I'm unsure of how to proceed or solve a problem, I start by researching and gathering information to expand my understanding of the issue. If necessary, I consult with my peers or supervisors to seek their input or guidance. For example, when I was tasked with implementing a feature using a technology I was unfamiliar with, I began by studying the documentation and online resources. I also reached out to a colleague who had experience with the technology to ask for their advice. By leveraging both self-learning and collaboration, I was able to successfully implement the feature and expand my skillset.

**Sample Answer 2**: In situations where I'm unsure of how to solve a problem, I first try to break the problem down into smaller components and analyze each one individually. If I'm still uncertain, I don't hesitate to seek assistance from my colleagues or refer to online resources and documentation. In one instance, I was struggling to optimize a complex algorithm. After attempting various solutions without success, I consulted with a senior developer who suggested a different approach that I hadn't considered. By being open to seeking help and learning from others, I was able to resolve the issue and improve my problem-solving abilities.

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